PORTLAND
Public Schools

Board of Education Seismic Update



03/
10/2026

Seismic Update

- What we have accomplished
- Framework for Prioritization
- Future Scope of Work Planned by campus
- Next Steps



Resolution 7109

Resolution 7109 establishes the criteria and intent for prioritizing seismic retrofits. It contemplates that all high-risk schools will not be addressed within a single bond cycle. Specifically, it directs Portland Public Schools (PPS) to use current seismic assessment data to identify and prioritize schools that pose the greatest risk of injury or death in a significant earthquake, and to clearly communicate the criteria used to determine the sequence of retrofits.

We acknowledge that discussion of a significant earthquake can cause concern and anxiety. We affirm at all times that we are focused on ensuring the safety of all of our children and staff in our buildings and are working to devise a plan to prioritize the work across our many buildings to do that.

Seismic Work in 2012, 2017, and 2020 Bonds

Full Seismic Retrofits & New Buildings:

Benson Polytechnic High School (Modernized 2024)
Franklin High School
Grant High School
Lincoln High School
McDaniel High School
Roosevelt High School (T)
hayu alqi uxyat
Alameda Elementary
Clark (T)
Faubion PK-8 (T)
Hayhurst Elementary
Kellogg Middle School (T)
Lewis Elementary

Partial and Roof-Level Seismic Improvements:

Abernethy
Ainsworth
Alameda
Arleta(T)
Astor (T)
Atkinson (T)
Beverly Cleary
Bridlemile
Buckman (T)
Chapman (T)
Chief Joseph
Cleveland
Clark (T)
Creston
Da Vinci
Duniway
Odyssey
Glencoe
Harriet Tubman
Harrison Park (T)
Hayhurst
Hosford
Jackson (T)
Ida B Wells
Kelly (T)
James John (T)
Lewis
Maplewood
Markham (T)
Marshall
MLK (T)
Meek
MLC
Mt. Tabor
Ockley Green (T)
Rigler (T)
Sabin
Sellwood
Sitton (T)
Skyline
Stephenson
Vernon
Winterhaven
Woodlawn (T)

SUMMER 2026

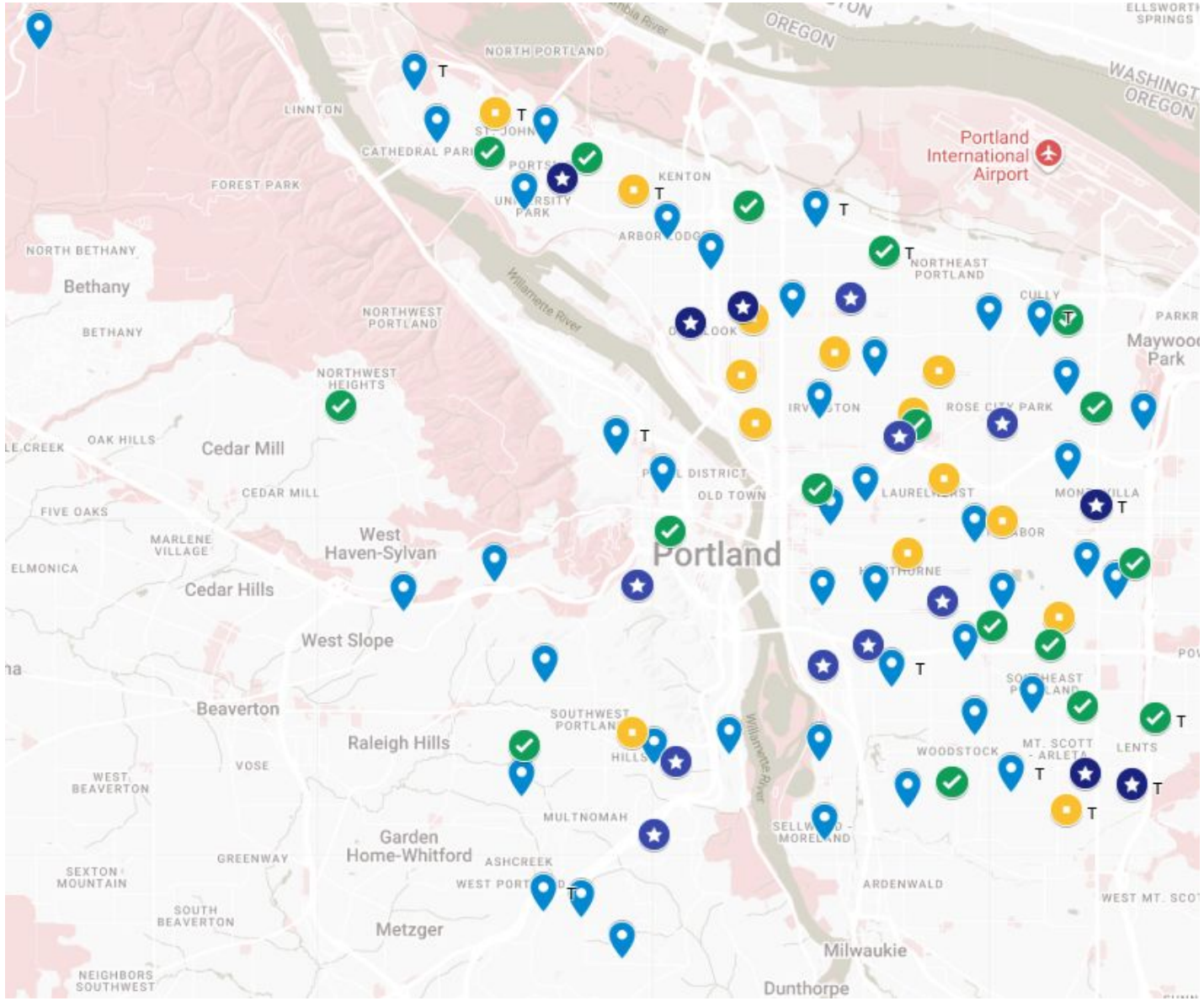
Lent (T)
Marysville (T)
Vestal (T)
Marshall
Chavez (T)
Woodmere (T)

Modernizations
Jefferson (T)

(T) = Title 1A w/in last 5 yrs

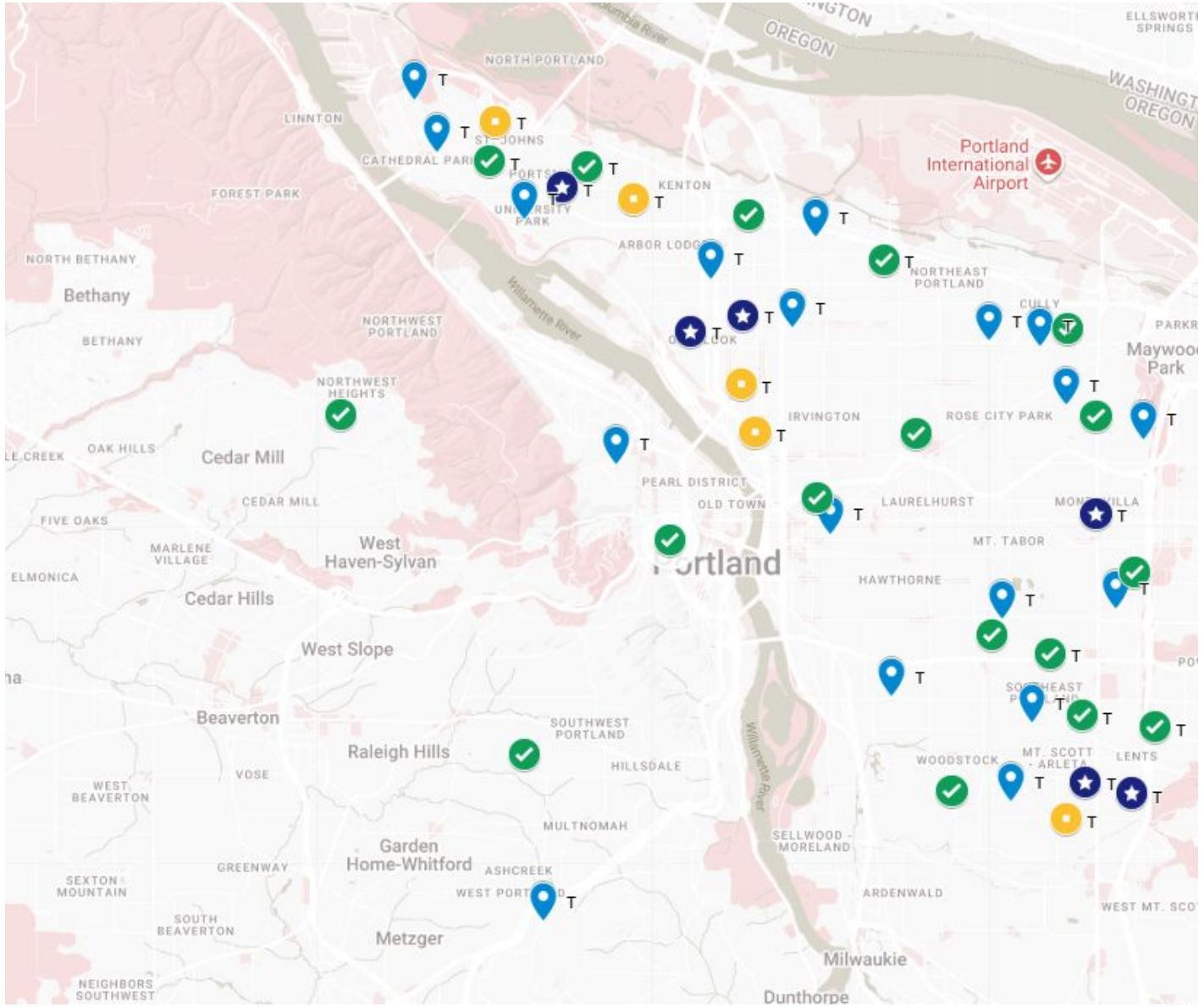
Prior Seismic Work - All PPS

- Replaced/Retrofitted/Low Risk (17)
- 2025 Bond Seismic + Current Roofs w/expanded scope for “low cost/high safety return seismic project opportunities” (15)
- Partial Seismic Upgrades Completed (43)
- No prior seismic (15)



Prior Seismic Work - Title 1A *(over last 5 years)*

- Replaced/Retrofitted/Low Risk (7)
- 2025 Bond Seismic + Current Roofs w/expanded scope for “low cost/high safety return seismic project opportunities” (6)
- Partial Seismic Upgrades Completed (18)
- No prior seismic (5)

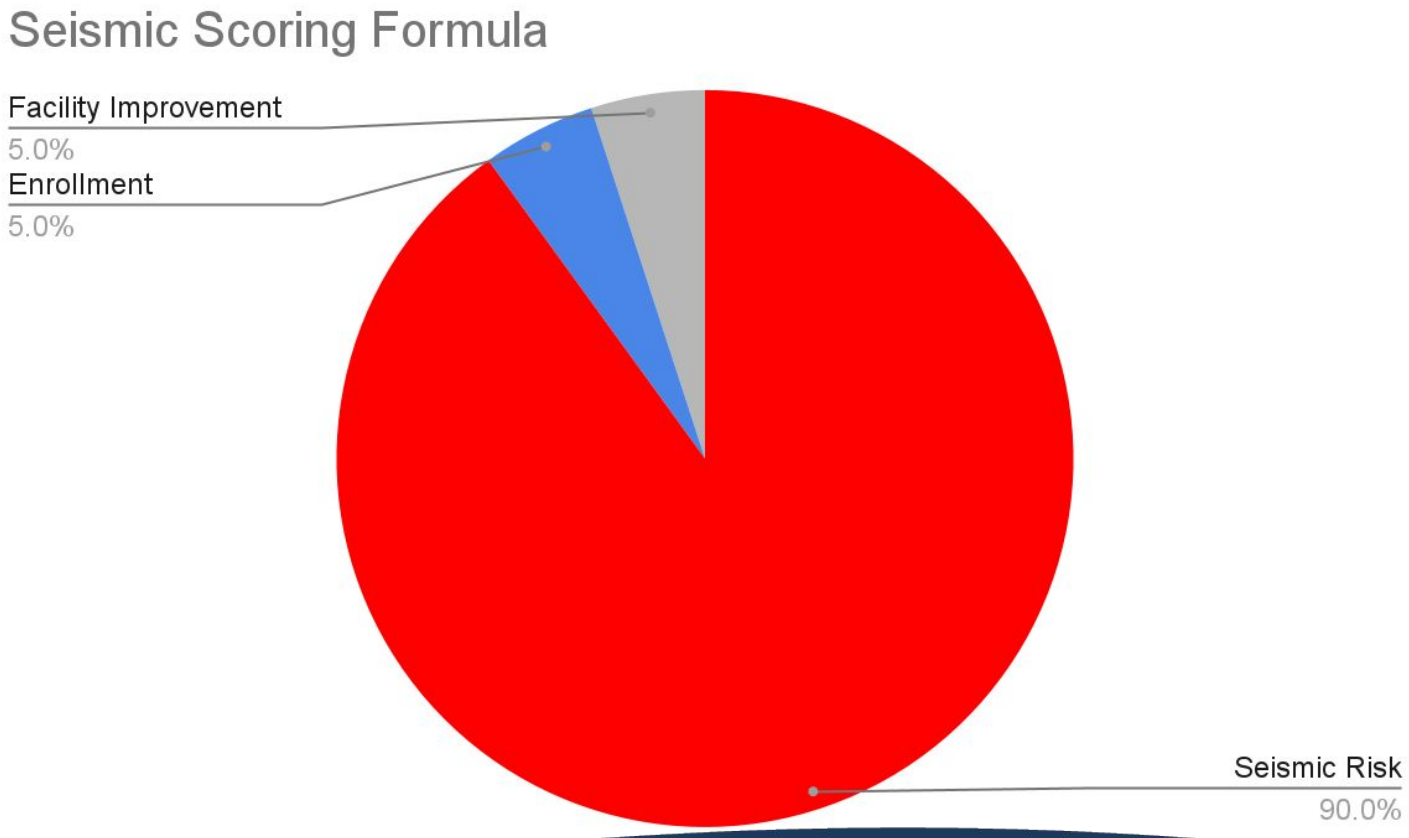


Seismic Prioritization Formula – Weighted Scoring Model

90% – Seismic Risk (Red):
Measures structural vulnerability and life-safety priorities.

5% – Facility Improvement (Gray):
Reflects facility condition and upkeep backlog.

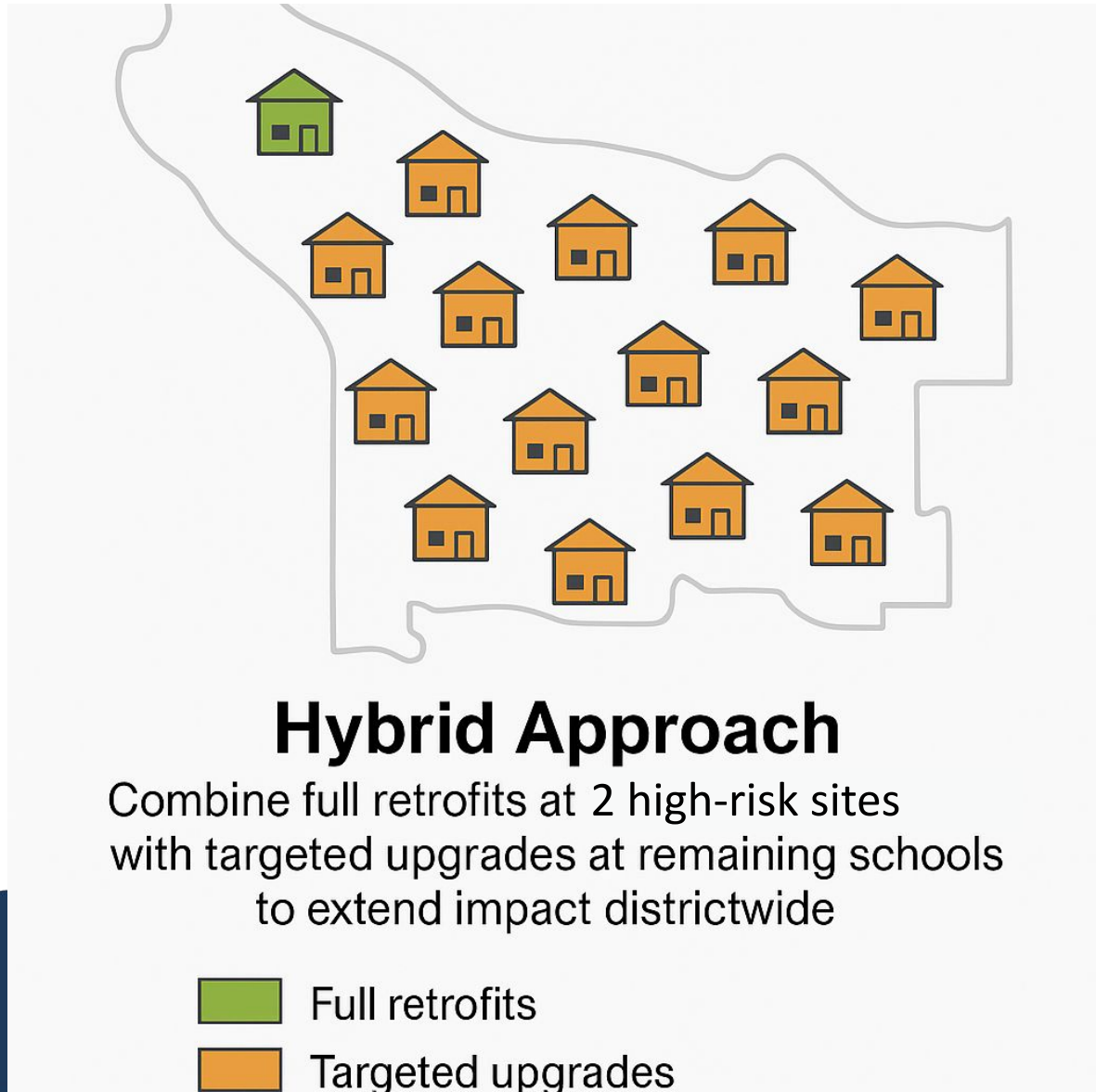
5% – Enrollment (Blue):
Represents student impact and utilization.



Seismic Approach - Hybrid

highest-risk sites

- Some full retrofit
- Targeted upgrades to critical structural elements to lessen catastrophic collapse



Seismic Upgrades

- **Comprehensive Campus Retrofits**
  - Beverly Cleary - Fernwood
  - Rose City Park
- **Targeted Retrofits**
  - Ainsworth
  - Beach (T)
  - Capitol Hill
  - Kelly (T)
  - Richmond
  - Vernon (2020 Bond)
  - Winterhaven (2020 Bond)

- **2026 Roof Projects w/ added seismic**
  - Chavez (T) (2017 Bond)
  - Marshall (2017 Bond)
  - Vestal (T) (2017 Bond)
  - Woodmere (T) (2017 Bond)

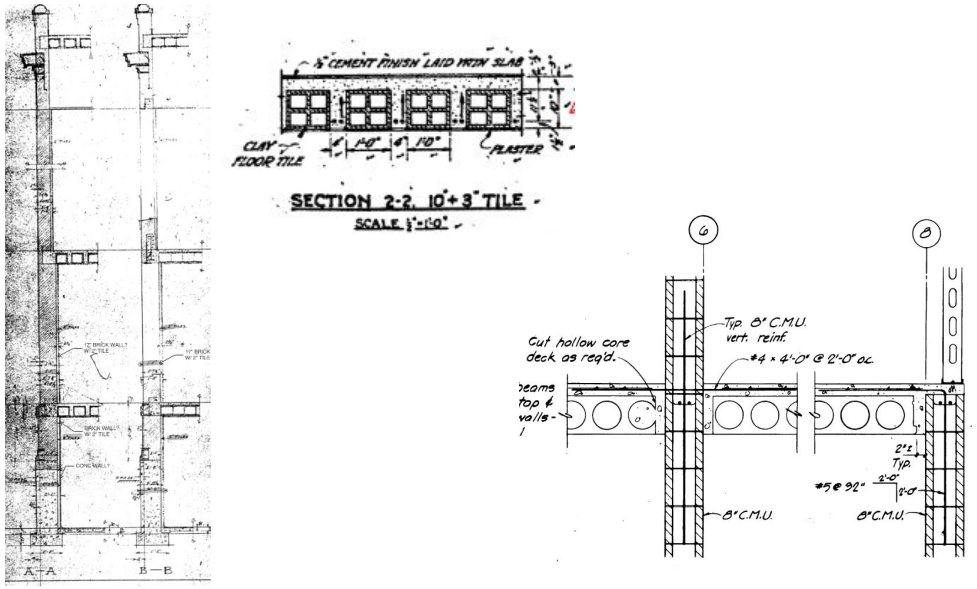
Targeted Retrofits

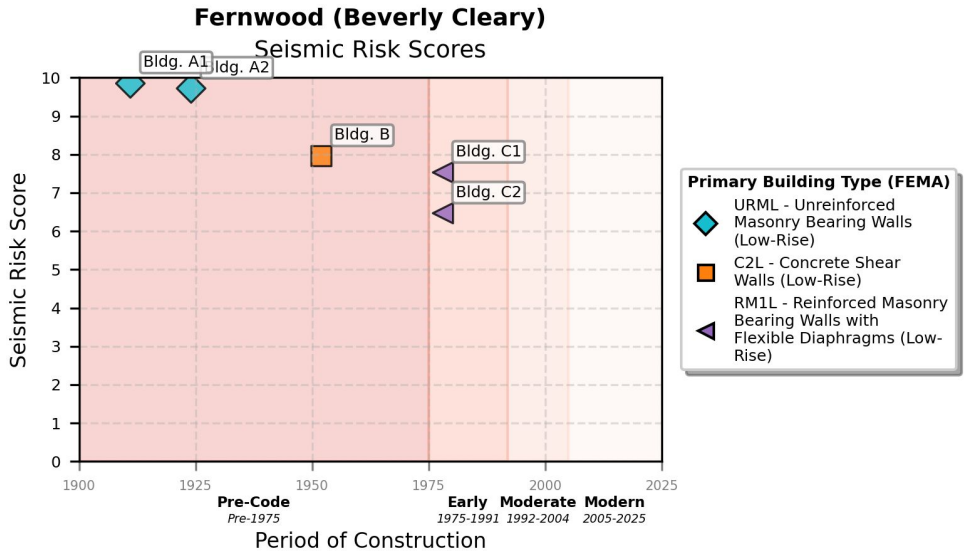
High Risk Scores for Building Parts and/or reducing localized collapse hazards from unreinforced masonry (URM) walls

(T) = Title 1A w/in last 5 yrs

Fernwood (Beverly Cleary) *Full Campus*







Construction
Summer 2027 through Summer 2028

Funding
2025 Bond
SRGP Submitted

1920s Buildings

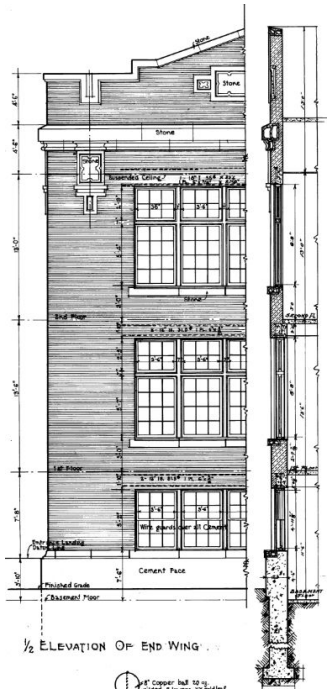
- Brick URM load-bearing walls
- Heavy concrete roof and floors with masonry formwork left in place
- Hollow clay tile partition walls between classrooms

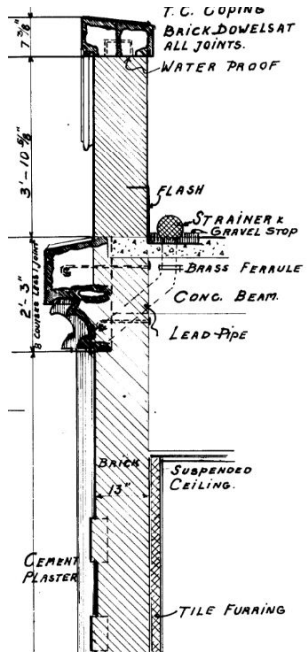
1970s Buildings

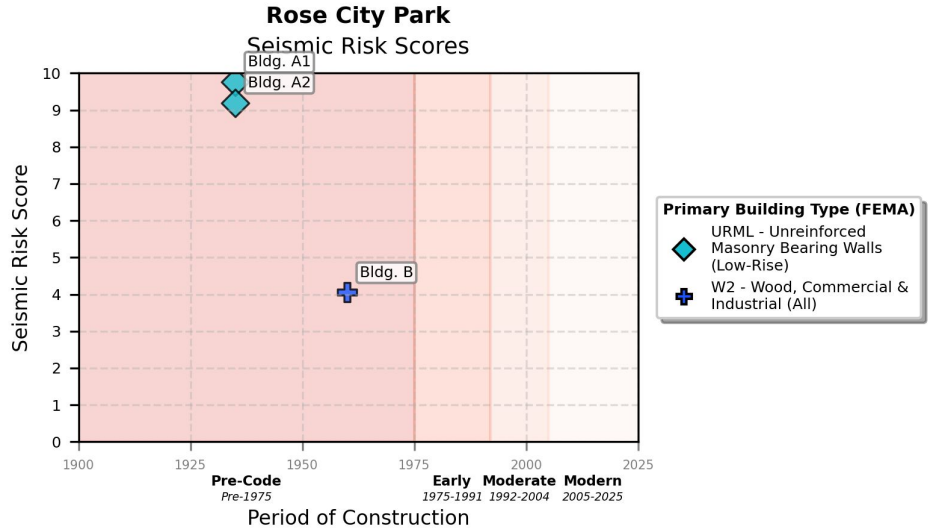
- Masonry walls need strengthening
- Pre-cast hollowcore flooring at classrooms need anchorage
- Wall to diaphragm connections need strengthening

Rose City Park *Full Campus*







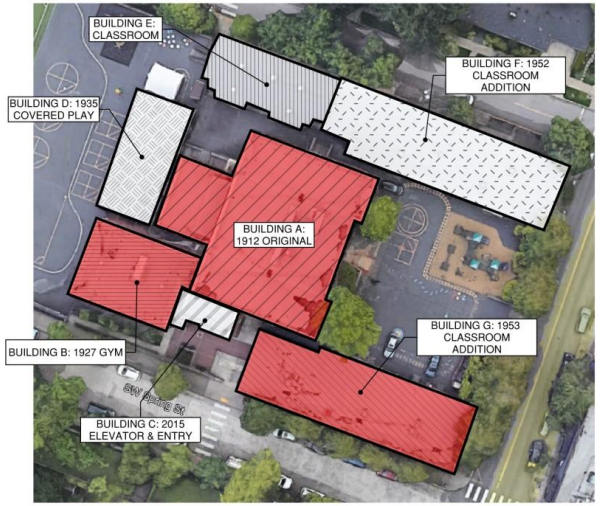


Construction
Summer 2028 through Summer 2029

Funding
2025 Bond
SRGP Candidate

- 1910s-20s construction with brick URM load-bearing walls
- 1935 school completion (phased starting late 1910s)
- Brick URM load-bearing walls
- Heavy concrete roof and floors
- Hollow clay tile partition walls between classrooms

Ainsworth *Buildings B (Gym) and G (Classrooms)*

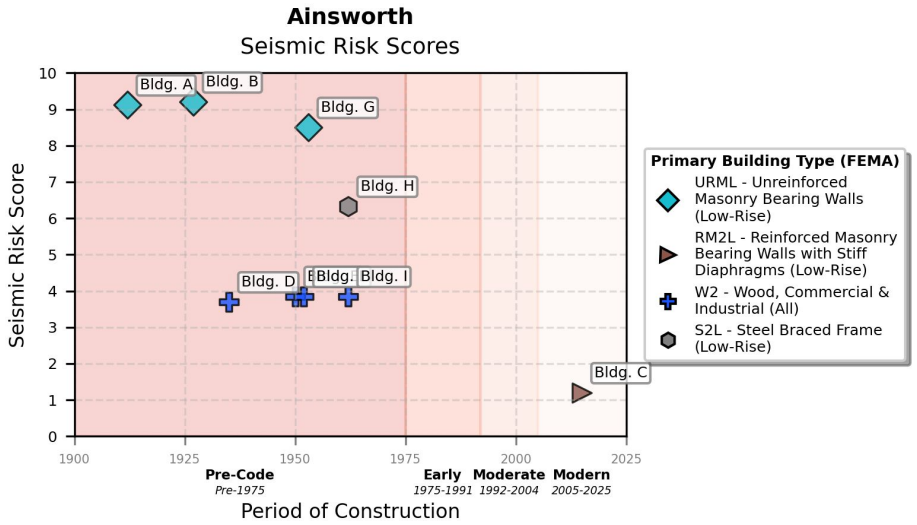


MAIN CAMPUS AT 2425 SW VISTA AVE.



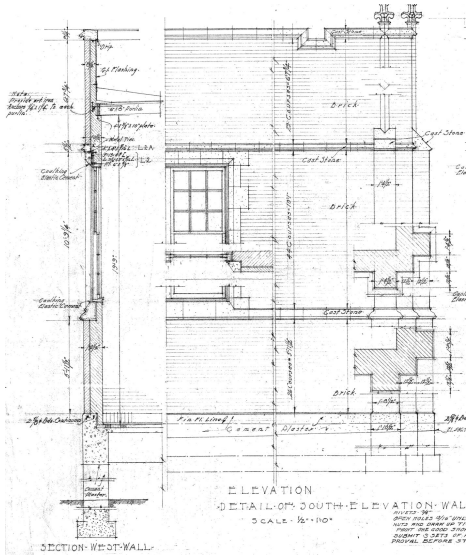
ANNEX SITE AT 2535 SW VISTA AVE.

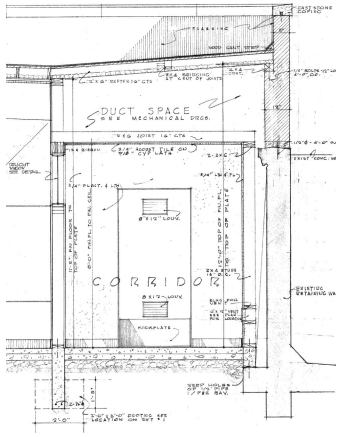
AREA OF URM



Construction
Summer 2027
&
Summer 2028

Funding
2025 Bond
SRGP Submitted





Building B (1927 Gym)

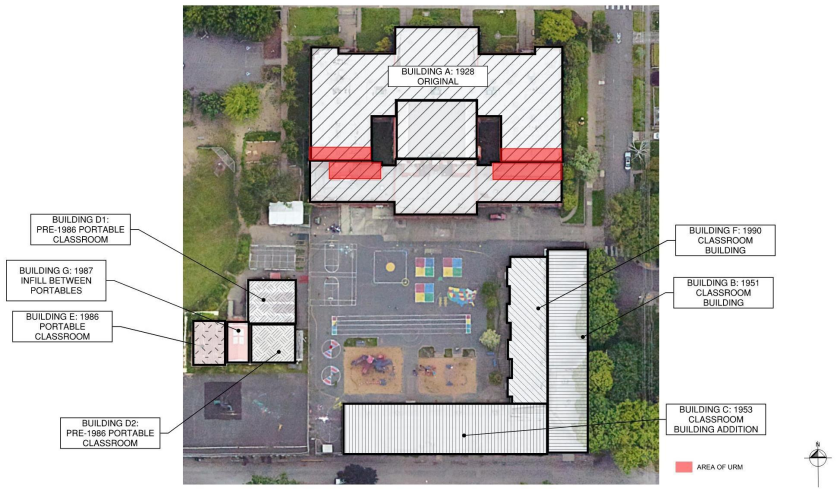
- Brick URM load-bearing
- High occupancy area (gym)

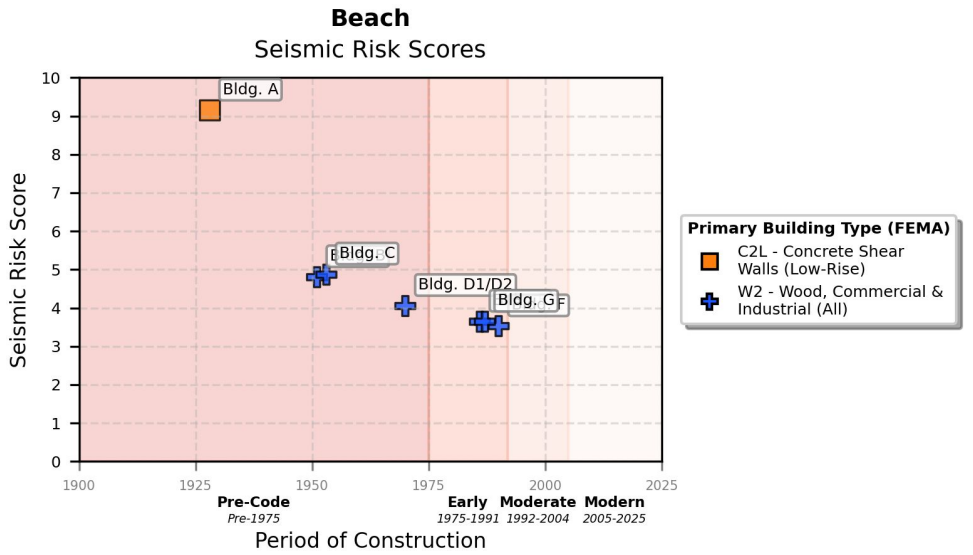
Building G (1953 Classrooms)

- Brick URM load-bearing walls

SRGP Grant Submission - able to separate from main building

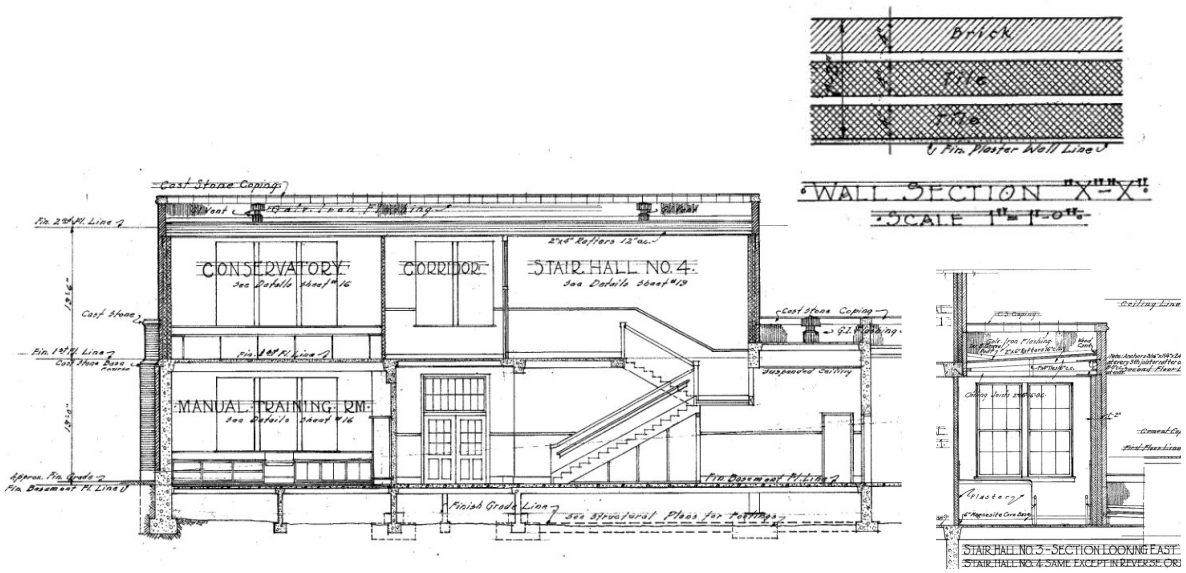
Beach *Building A - Walls at southern stairs*





Construction
Summer 2027
&
Summer 2028

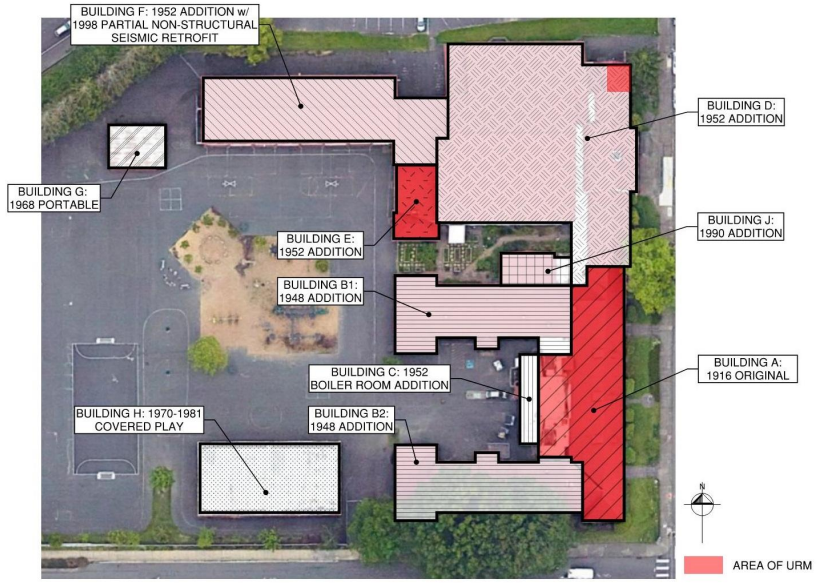
Funding
2025 Bond

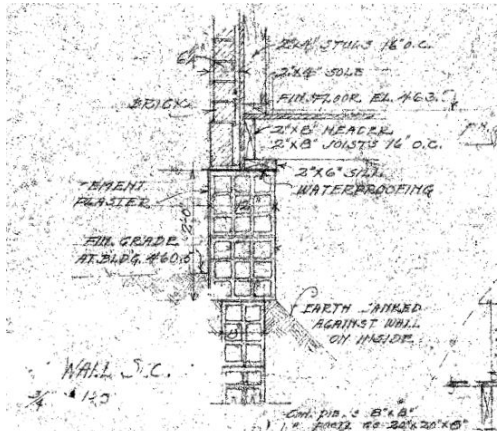


- 1920s construction, primarily concrete shear walls
- Load-bearing URM walls at southern egress stairwells

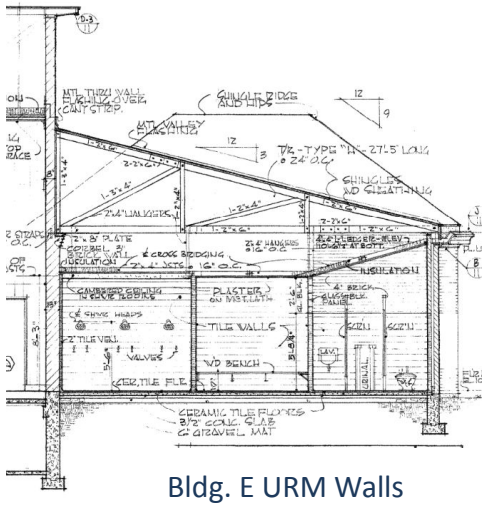


Capitol Hill *Buildings A, D, E, and F*

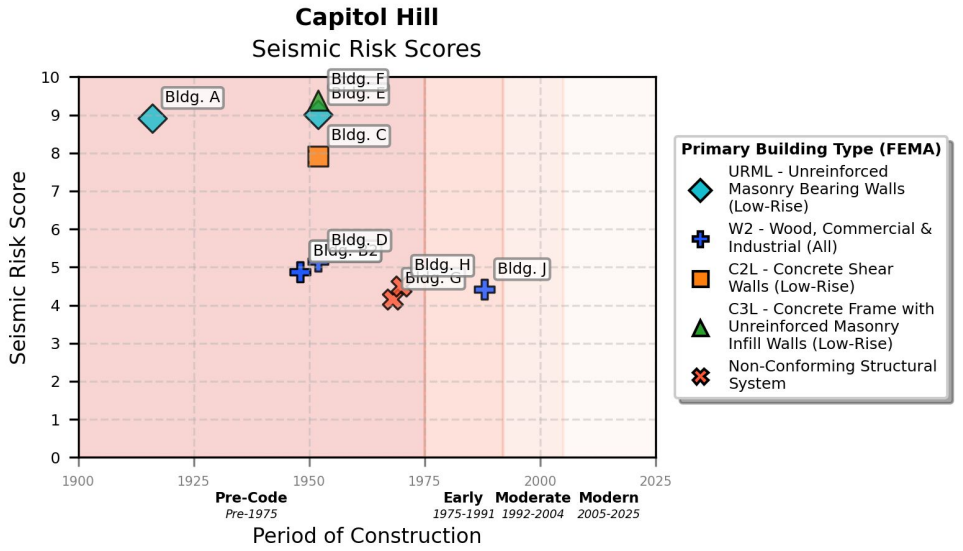




Bldg. A URM Foundation



Bldg. E URM Walls

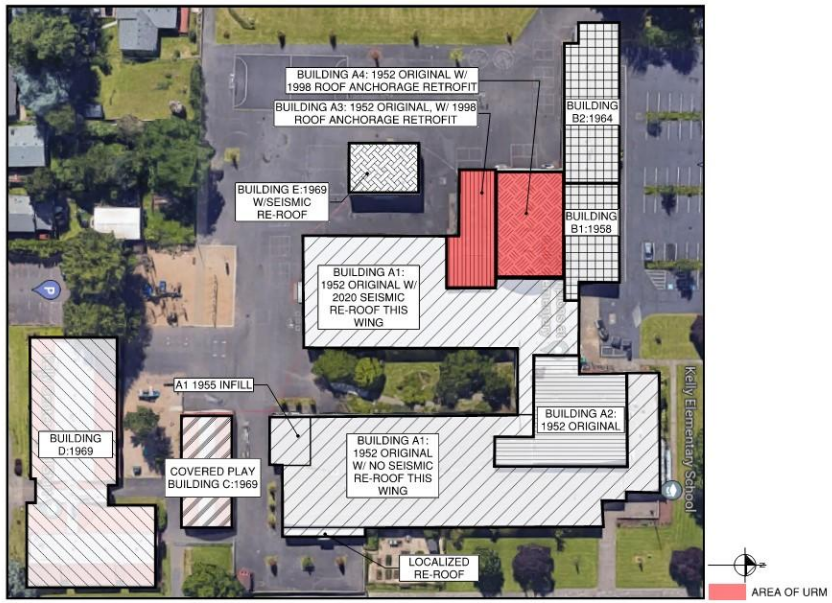


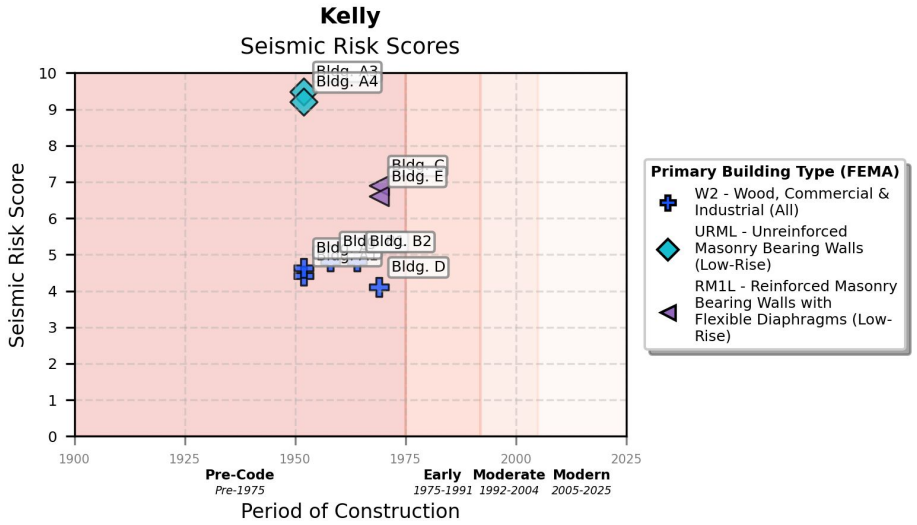
Construction
Summer 2027
&
Summer 2028

Funding
2025 Bond

- Building A is a 1916 wood-framed building bearing on a URM (Hollow Clay Tile) foundation
- Building D has URM at the entry (localized retrofit)
- Building E has loadbearing URM walls
- Building F has URM infill walls

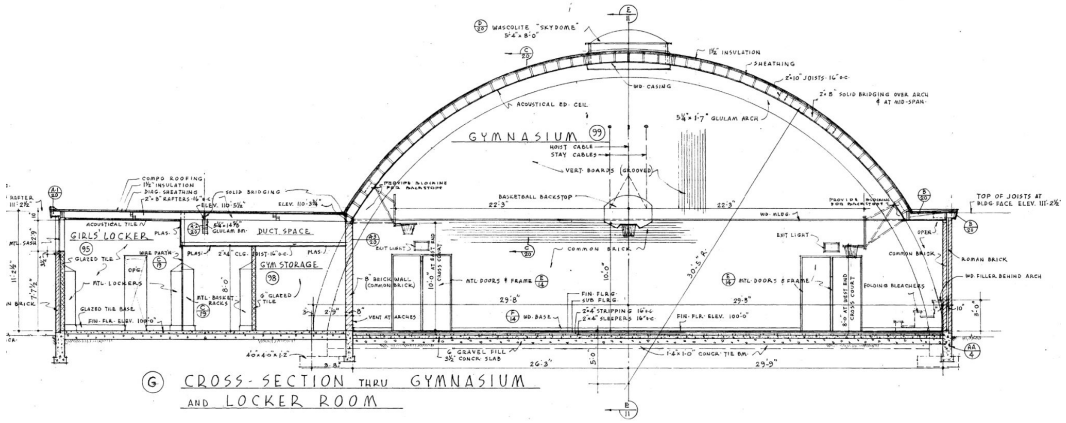
Kelly *Buildings A3 & A4 (Gym + Locker Room)*





Construction
Summer 2027

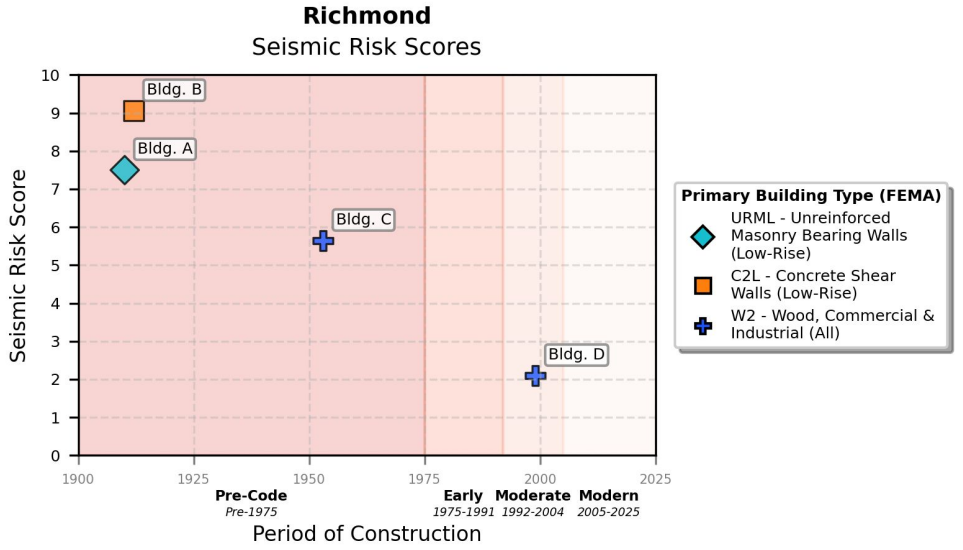
Funding
2025 Bond



- 1950s construction with brick URM load-bearing perimeter shear walls
- High occupancy area (gym)

Richmond *Buildings A (URM Basement) and C (URM at Stage)*

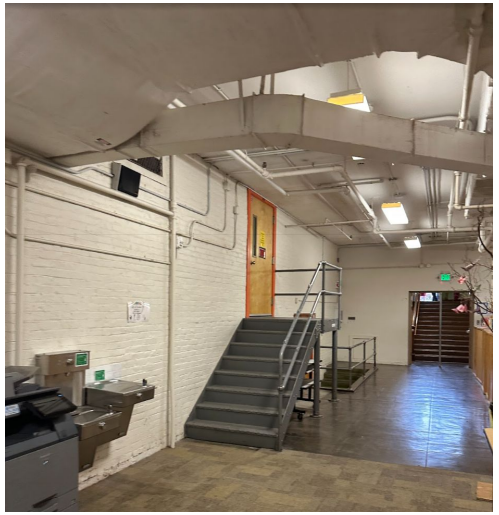




Construction
Summer 2027
&
Summer 2028

Funding
2025 Bond

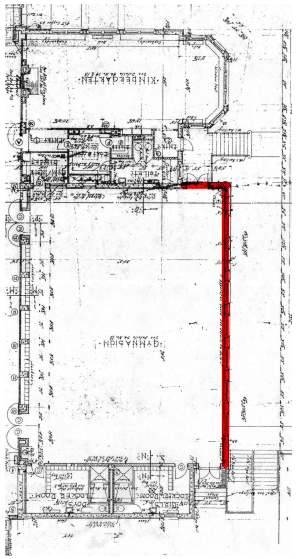


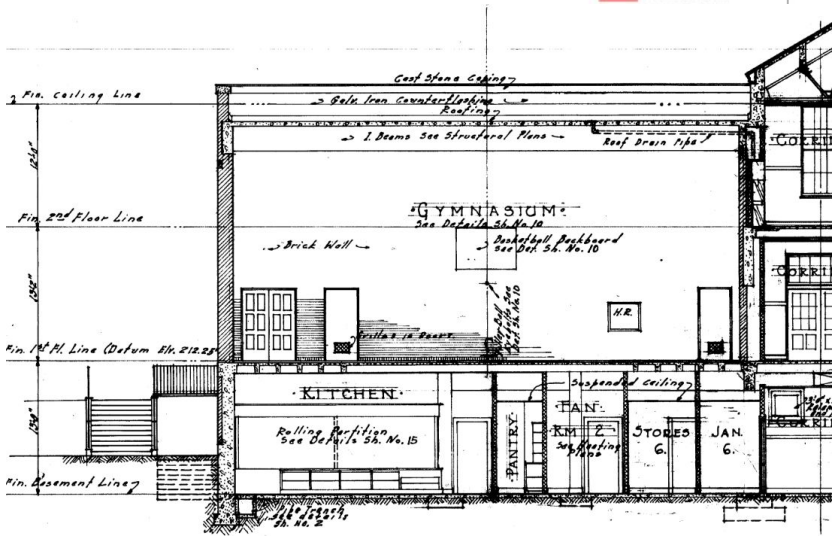


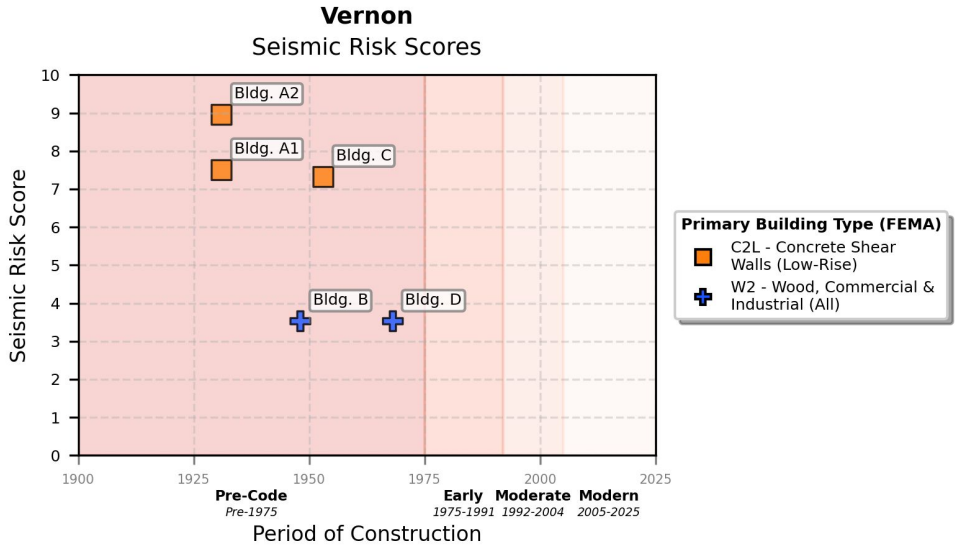
- Building A is a 1910 wood-framed building bearing on a URM first floor (no drawings)
- Building C has URM supporting the stage

Vernon *Building A2 - East Gym Wall*









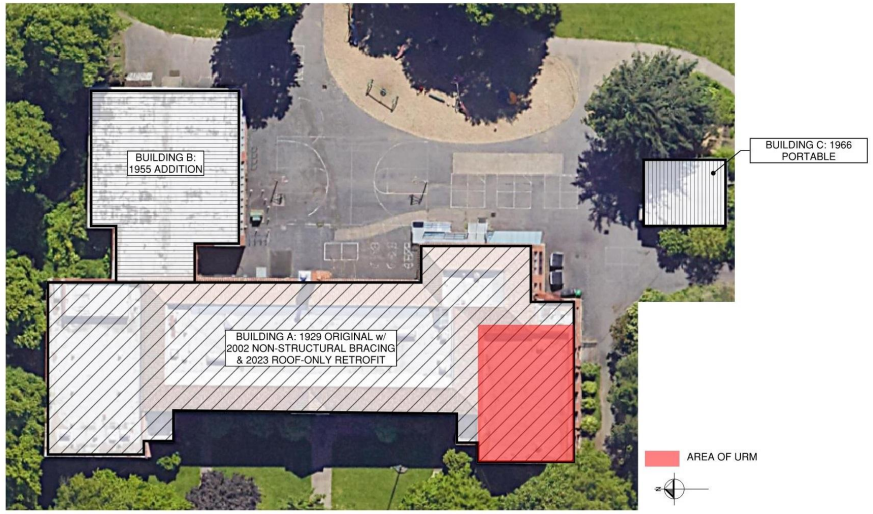
Construction
Summer 2026

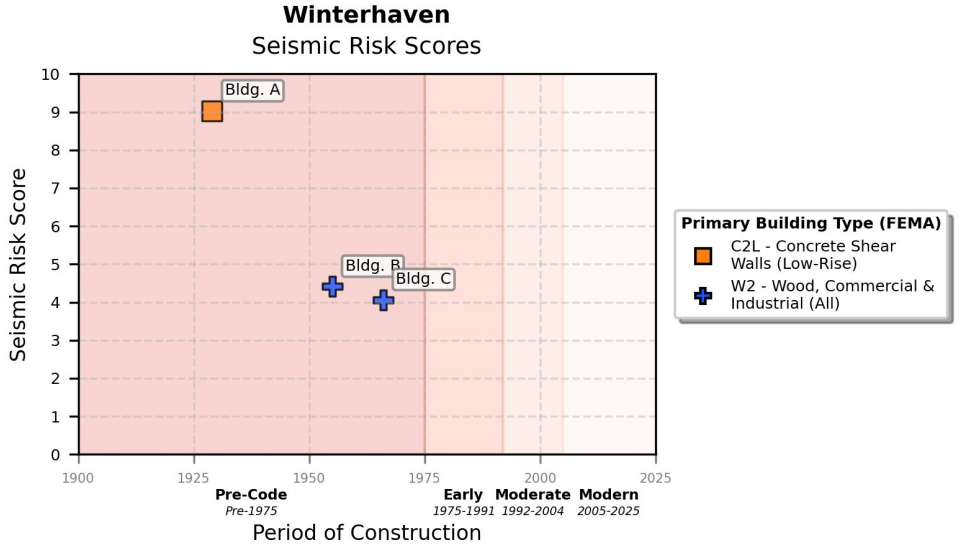
Funding
2020 Bond

- Building A2 - East wall of gym is loadbearing URM
- URM wall piers are tall and skinny (aka weaker) because the wall has several windows
- Gym is a high occupancy area



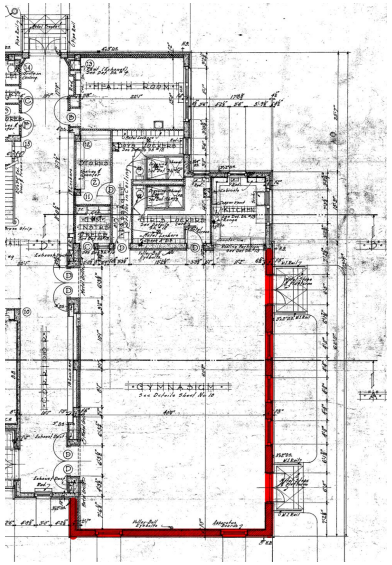
Winterhaven *Building A - South and West Gym Walls*

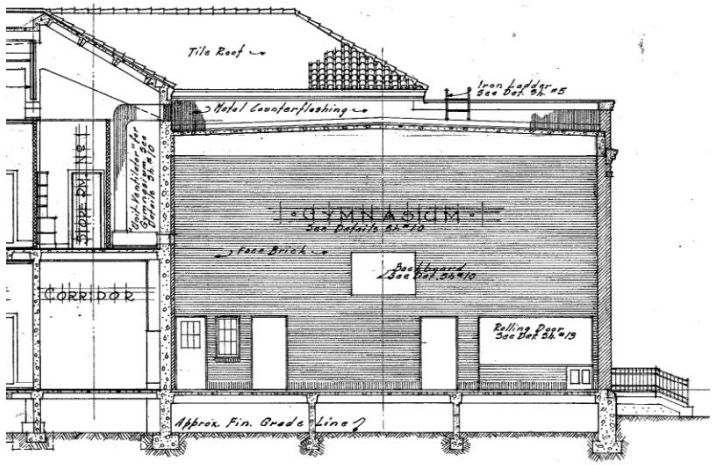




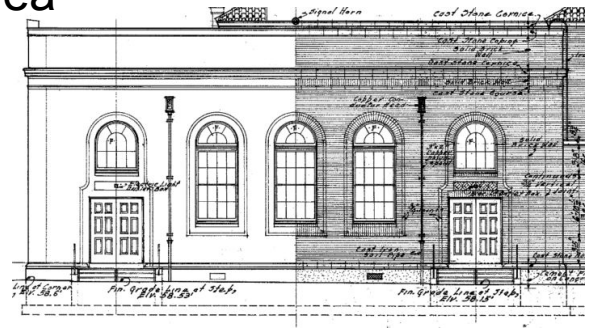
Construction
Summer 2026

Funding
2020 Bond



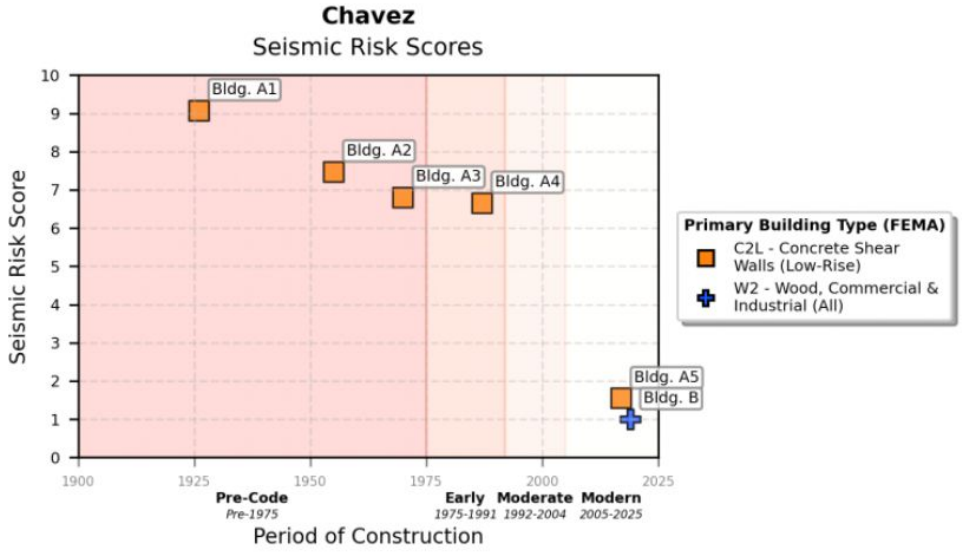


- 1920s construction, primarily concrete shear walls
- Load-bearing URM walls at south and west walls of gym with tall/slender piers
- Gym is a high-occupancy area



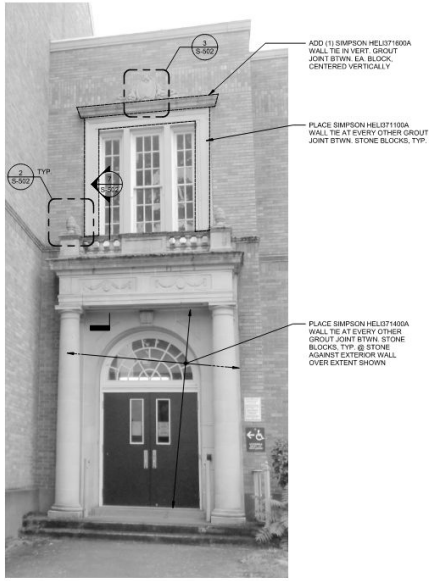
Chavez *Roof Seismic + Bracing @ Egress*



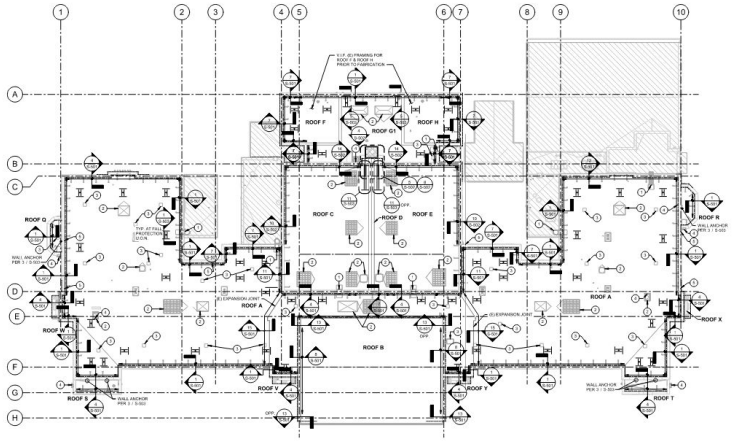


Construction
Summer 2026

Funding
2017 Bond



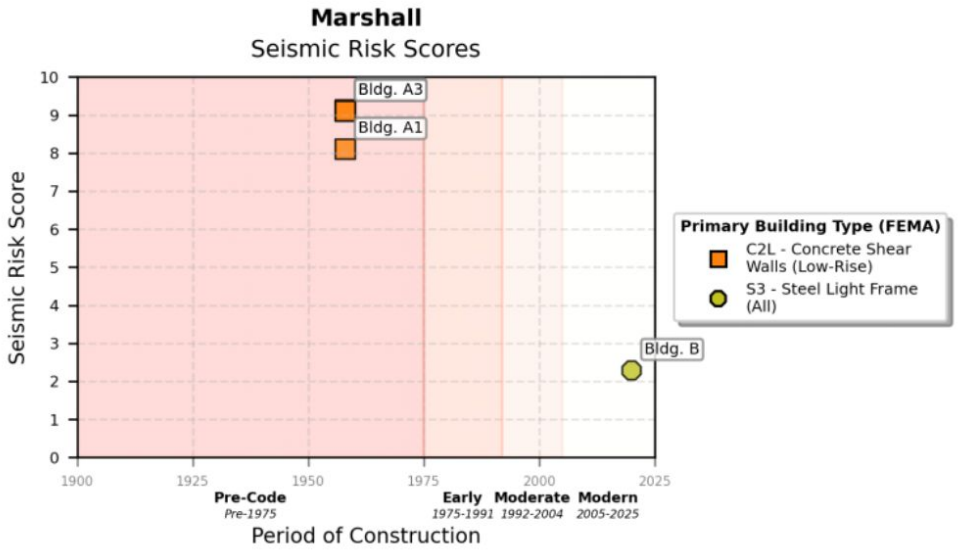
1 S-502 **STONEWORK ANCHORAGE AT ENTRY ELEVATION**
3/8" = 1'-0"



- 1920s construction, primarily concrete shear walls
- Roof-level seismic
- Brace/anchor brick veneer and heavy ornamentation over/around egress

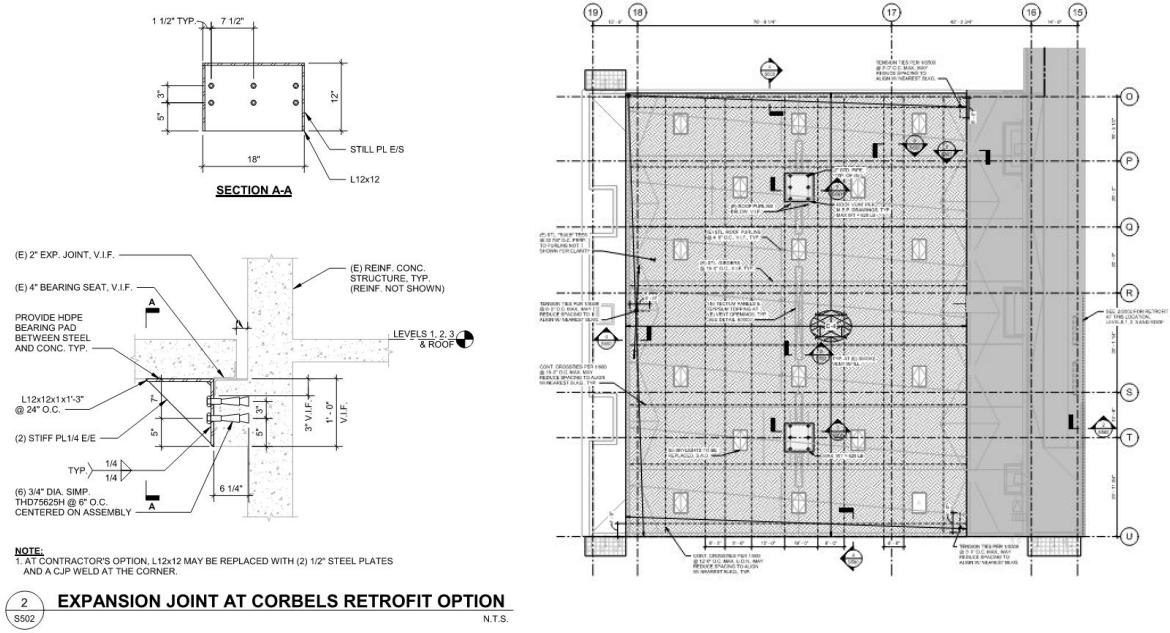
Marshall *Roof Seismic + Corridor Retrofit*





Construction
Summer 2026

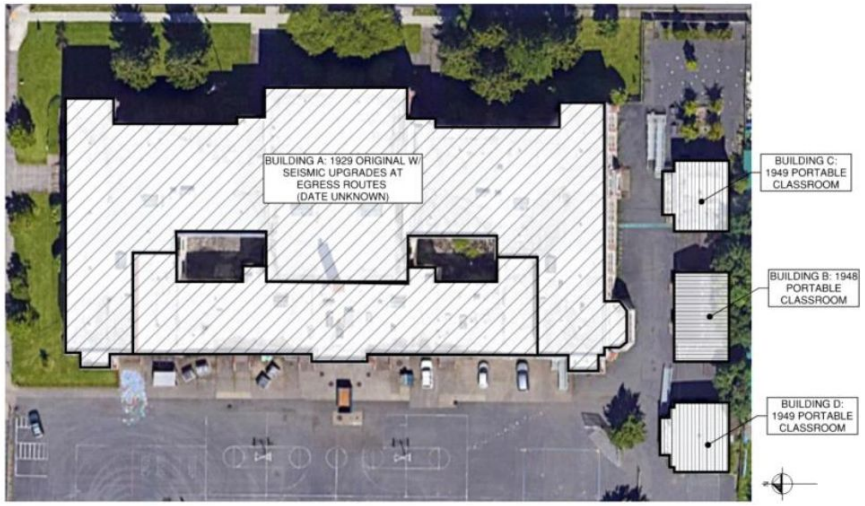
Funding
2017 Bond

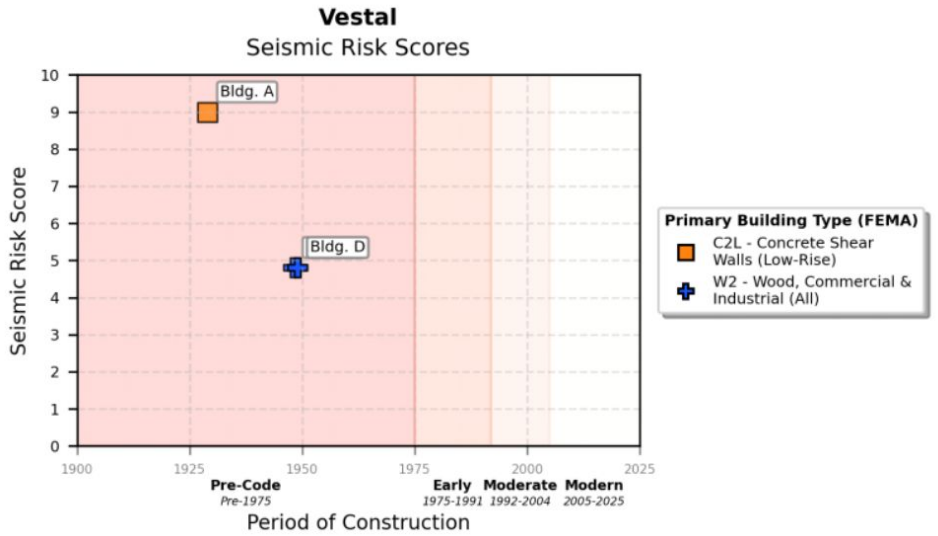


- 1950s concrete construction
- Roof-level seismic
- Retrofitting collapse hazard in corridor/egress at expansion joint, multiple floors

Vestal

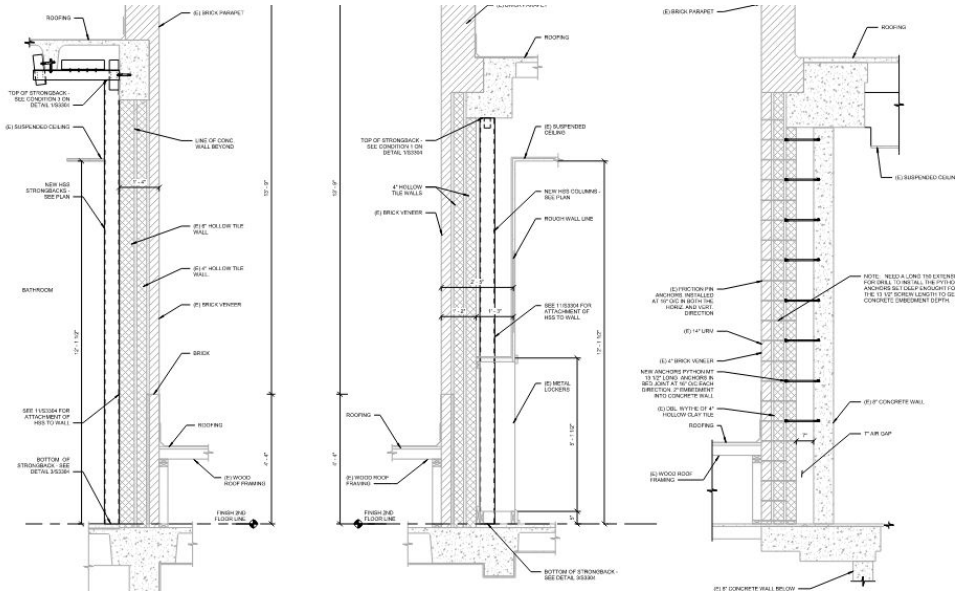
Roof Seismic + URM Load-bearing Retrofit





Construction
Summer 2026

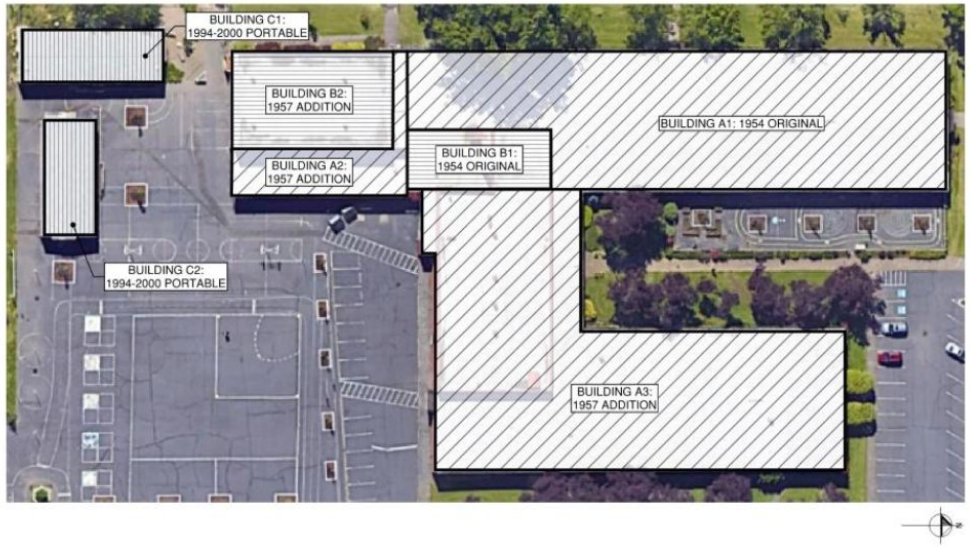
Funding
2017 Bond

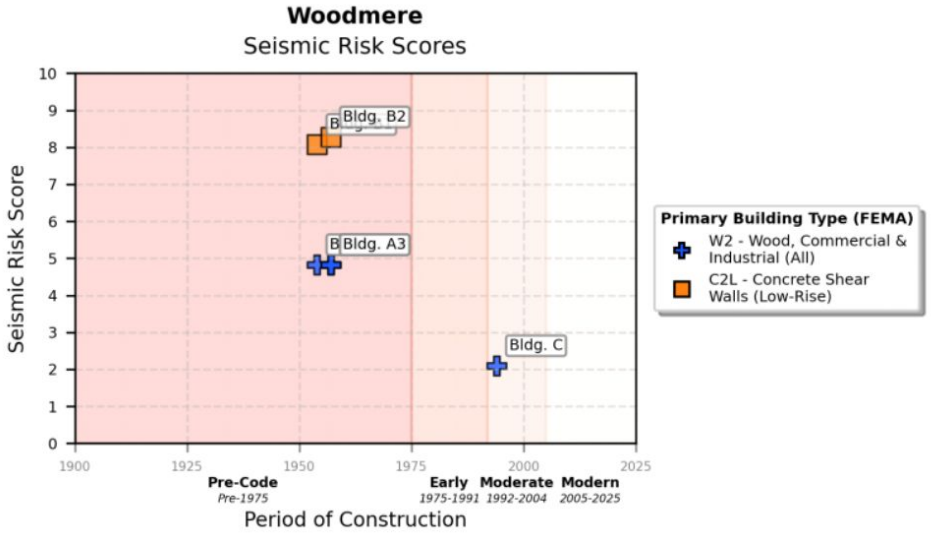


- 1920s construction, primarily concrete shear walls
- Roof-level seismic
- Retrofitting URM load bearing west wall
- Bracing 2nd level URM walls

Woodmere

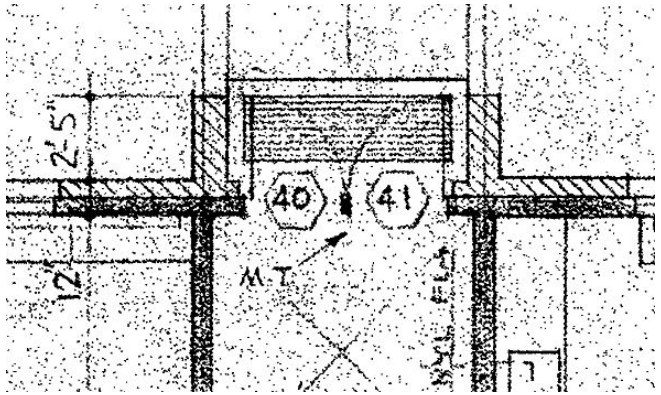
Roof Seismic + URM at Egress

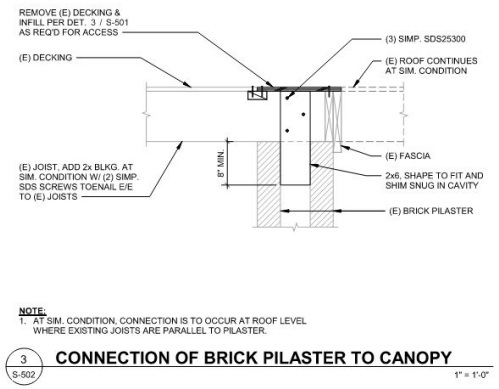




Construction
Summer 2026

Funding
2017 Bond





- 1950s wood framed/concrete shear wall
- Roof-level seismic
- Retrofitting masonry pilasters at 5 entries

Next Steps

- Approval of Seismic Design Contracts Current Board Meeting and Future
- 2027 Construction Projects will go out to Bid at the earliest December 2026
- Progress additional studies for future seismic projects

Questions?

